

Valentina Montagna

Email: valentina.montagna.design@gmail.com Phone: +1 (415) 612 0163

About me

I have over 14 years of experience in the digital space and a deep commitment to connecting product strategy with design execution. To a team, I bring a systemic mindset and a lean approach to problem-solving. Working on digital products means I get to combine my graphic design and typography background with a data-informed mindset. I am drawn to products that solve complex user problems and thrive in small teams that move fast without cutting corners. My work spans UX strategy, growth design, A/B testing, design systems, and cross-functional collaboration with product, engineering, and research.

Work experience

Senior Product Designer for Growth, [Freelance Consultant](#)

September 2024 – August 2026 (present) · Berkeley, CA

Partnered with seed-stage startups to sharpen their UX strategy using a growth-design approach. From design roadmaps to foundational design system UI libraries and A/B experimentation plans, I helped 0→1 products use design as a strategic asset, measured against their KPIs.

Senior Product Designer for Discovery & Ads, [Tubi](#)

December 2022 – July 2024 · San Francisco, CA (remote)

- Unlocked \$300K in first-year revenue by launching Tubi's first pause ad format for OTT, [opening brand partnership opportunities](#) and new surfaces for Original content promotion.
- Brought visual consistency across fragmented OTT clients by redesigning the layout grid system and providing precise implementation guidance to the TV clients' multiple engineering teams.
- Contributed to creating a shared foundation for the new user acquisition strategy by creating a content design framework for improving the carousels' grouping logic, bridging Design, Research, and ML.
- Designed a roadmap of mobile UX experiments to boost new user acquisition during discovery, with a focus on upgrading TV Shows user experience.

Senior Product Designer for Growth, [MasterClass](#)

March 2022 – October 2022 · San Francisco (remote)

- Established MasterClass's B2B acquisition design strategy from scratch, partnering with Research to build the knowledge base needed to successfully target DEI and corporate education leaders.
- Unblocked the mobile onboarding roadmap by replacing one-off experiment designs with a modular redesign strategy, giving the team a long-term vision and a reusable framework for testing.
- Opened a new SEO acquisition channel by designing the Instructor Pages layout, then templated the solution to scale it across thousands of MasterClass Articles with minimal design overhead.

Product Designer for Acquisition & SEO, [Scribd & Everand](#)

September 2020 - January 2022 · San Francisco (remote)

- Improved SEO ranking and subscriber acquisition by designing a dynamic templating system for Scribd's Books Category pages, a system flexible enough to adapt to pages varying widely in content type, volume, language, and curation level.
- As the first designer to extend the Web Design System, I workshoped new responsive patterns with engineering and design that achieved product-wide adoption. [The results are still live.](#)
- Drove a 15% increase in embed signups by identifying the opportunity, building the data-backed business case, and leading the Documents embed redesign end to end.

Product Designer for Growth, [Evernote](#)

October 2019 - August 2020 · Redwood City, CA (remote)

- Increased freemium activation by 17% through a personalized extended onboarding for Web, then expanded the win by designing a Premium free trial variant of the same experience.
- Extended the activation gains to Evernote's highest-traffic surface by leading the mobile onboarding personalization redesign.
- Established a visual language for Growth patterns and illustrations by extending the Evernote Design System with onboarding and education components.
- Enabled the Monetization team to identify and fix inconsistencies and missed revenue opportunities by mapping the mobile app's entire paywall and monetization touchpoint system.
- Designed the logic and experience for a guest-mode mobile onboarding, including reminders, notifications, and upsells, and solving the unique constraints of a no-signup flow.
- Owned design across A/B and growth experiments for acquisition and monetization, including a Pricing & Plans redesign and a New Year countdown promotion that earned a CEO callout.

Lead Product Designer for Payments & Consumer, [Bandcamp](#)

June 2015 - August 2019 · Berlin, Germany and Oakland, CA USA (remote)

As the second design hire at a 30-person company, I owned the end-to-end checkout experience for four and a half years, before third-party payment infrastructure like Stripe existed, designing across the full complexity of payments: fraud prevention, multiple currencies, split payments, and the introduction of credit card payments.

- Redesigned the web checkout flow to a nearly 90% success rate, a system that has since processed over a billion transactions and remains live, unchanged.
- Drove a 70% increase in mobile app installs by redesigning the post-checkout experience across 150 use cases and introducing a contextual nudge prompting digital buyers to install the app.
- Designed Bandcamp's gift card system from scratch, no off-the-shelf infrastructure, full UX across purchasing, redeeming, and spending credit in multiple locales and currencies, and introduced a project management approach that kept a large, fast-moving effort on track to ship before Christmas. Bandcamp Gift Cards also remains live and unchanged.

Lead Product Designer & Co-founder, [Urlist](#)

2012 - 2015 · Berlin, Germany

As co-founder and sole designer, I owned design end-to-end across every product we launched: UX/UI, branding, illustration, and frontend (HTML & CSS), while contributing to strategy, hiring, and investor relations after seed funding.

Senior Graphic Designer, Type Designer & Illustrator

2004 – 2012 · Milan, Italy

As a Senior Graphic Designer, I worked on editorial design and illustrations, and assisted with type design production across a variety of studios and companies including Studio Paola, Fabrica by Benetton, Studio Molotro by Luciano Perondi, and Edizioni ZERO.

Studies

MA Book Design (2009-2010) *Department of Typography, University of Reading (UK)*

Typographer Certification (2008-2009) *CFP Bauer, Milan, Italy*

MS Graphic Design and Communication Design (2004-2007) *Politecnico di Milano, Italy*

BS Industrial Product Design (2001-2004) *Politecnico of Milan, Italy*

UX Certifications by Nielsen Norman Group

- DesignOps: Scaling UX Design and User Research
- Designing Influence
- UX and Analytics
- UX & ROI
- The Human Mind and Usability

Volunteering

Design Coordinator & Educator, BAAP Bay Area Alternative Press (2024-2025)

Designed the cover and printed artifacts for BAAP's magazine *The Printing Times* and various Bay Area activist associations. Ran informal design sessions teaching InDesign and print fundamentals to non-designers of all ages.

UX/UI Designer, CHAYN (2020-2022)

Free & open digital tools for healing from domestic abuse

Collaborated with founder Hera Hussain and her core team to design a range of digital products, including the main CHAYN website, following principles of accessibility and trauma-informed design.

Other skills, in short

- Figma expert and proficient Adobe CS user
- I prototype with a high level of detail, drawing on my background in motion graphics
- I write my own HTML and CSS, and use GitHub and Claude Code for my personal projects
- I run moderated and unmoderated user testing autonomously, and genuinely enjoy it
- I favor sketching and wireframing as a starting point in my process (*if* the context is right)
- I tutored junior designers and non-designers on design principles and tools
- I approach visual design with rigor, building on my graphic and typographic design background
- I pay close attention to the user's cultural context and invest in building the knowledge needed to bring that awareness into my designs.